LoopCasts

Support and customer follow-up

LoopCasts BV · Ghent
Internal document. Please do not share outside the team.
Handbook chapter 06

LOOPCASTS HANDBOOK · CHAPTER 06

Support and customer follow-up

Internal handbook, chapter 6. Written by Lotte.

The support inbox

Customers mail `support@loopcasts.example`. It is a shared mailbox in Outlook. Pieter, Marieke and I all have it open. We get 60 to 80 mails a week, more after a newsletter.

The system is: whoever sees a mail first and knows the answer, answers it. We have no tickets and no "assigned to". So:

- Sometimes two of us answer the same customer, with slightly different answers.
- Sometimes everybody thinks somebody else will answer, and nobody does. I try to check every evening for mails older than two days. I flag them red.
- When a customer replies to an old thread from another mailbox, nobody sees the history.

We promise an answer within one working day. We make that most of the time, not on Thursdays (newsletter day, when also all the replies come in) and not when I am off.

What people ask

I once counted for two weeks. Roughly:

Question	Share	What I do
"I forgot my password"	25%	See below. There is no "forgot password" link.
"I paid, where is my login?"	15%	Check with Marieke whether the row is green. Usually they paid on Monday and it is Wednesday.
"Can I get a copy of my invoice?" / "Can you add our VAT number / PO number to the invoice?"	15%	Find the PDF in Dropbox and mail it, or ask Marieke to redo the invoice.
"Video does not play"	10%	Nearly always a company firewall blocking Vimeo, or an ad blocker. I have a standard text.
"Please change a seat in our team licence"	5%	Change the e-mail in phpMyAdmin, new password, mail it.
"I want to cancel" / "Can I get a refund?"	5%	Discuss with Marieke. We are generous, but it depends.
"In which video do you explain X?"	10%	Ask Pieter. He usually knows.
"Is there a course about X coming?"	5%	Should go on the whiteboard.
Everything else	10%	Technical questions about a course go to Marieke. Partnerships, students asking for a discount, spam.

For the top questions I have standard answers in a Word file, `support answers.docx`. I copy, paste and adapt. Marieke and Pieter do not use the file, they type from memory.

Password reset

1. Log in to phpMyAdmin.
2. Find the customer in the `users` table (search by e-mail; if they mail from another address than the one they ordered with, that is a puzzle).
3. Type a new password, choose MD5 in the dropdown, save.
4. Mail the new password to the customer.

Five minutes, 15 to 20 times a week. I do not check whether the person who mails is really the customer. It never felt necessary.

Renewals

Yearly subscriptions and team licences run for one year. There is no automatic renewal, because there is no automatic payment.

Around the first of each month:

1. I open the orders sheets of **last year** (`orders 2025.xlsx`) and filter on the month.
2. For every yearly customer of that month I send a mail: "your subscription ends on ..., would you like to renew?". I change the name and date by hand. About 80 to 100 mails a month, which takes most of a day.
3. If they answer yes, I add a new row in this year's orders sheet and it becomes a normal order (chapter 3).
4. If they do not answer, I should send a second mail two weeks later. I manage that about half of the time.
5. If they do not renew, I should set the account to inactive in phpMyAdmin.

Step 5 is the one that slips. I only do it when I have time, and I can only do it by going through the list and looking up each customer. Last summer Marieke asked me to check, and we found about 120 accounts that had ended months before and still worked. Some for more than a year. Some of those people were still watching every week. We did not dare to ask them for money afterwards.

Monthly subscribers are simpler and worse: they get an invoice every month (chapter 3). If they stop paying, it takes a while before anybody notices, because nobody compares the payments to the accounts.

Team licences

A team licence has 5 seats. The customer mails the names. People leave companies, so the names change. I keep the list of who is in which team in the comment field of the Excel cell, because there was no column for it.

What customers tell us

We get nice mails too, and good suggestions. They stay in the inbox. When Marieke asks "what do customers want?", I answer from my feeling of the last weeks.